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<https://sdgs.un.org/goals/goal1>

This document by the United Nations states that they have the goal of ending poverty in all it's forms. It also states that over half of the populations now recieves at least one societal protection benefit. This is goal 1 of 17.

Lived Experiences

Here's a scenario for you. Let's say there's 3 kids.

Kid 1 is an orphan who sleeps on benches and begs for food on the street.

Kid 2 is a child who lives in foster care with her sisters.

Kid 3 is a kid who lives in a rental home with their parents.

At a first glance, which kid do you think is in the most danger?

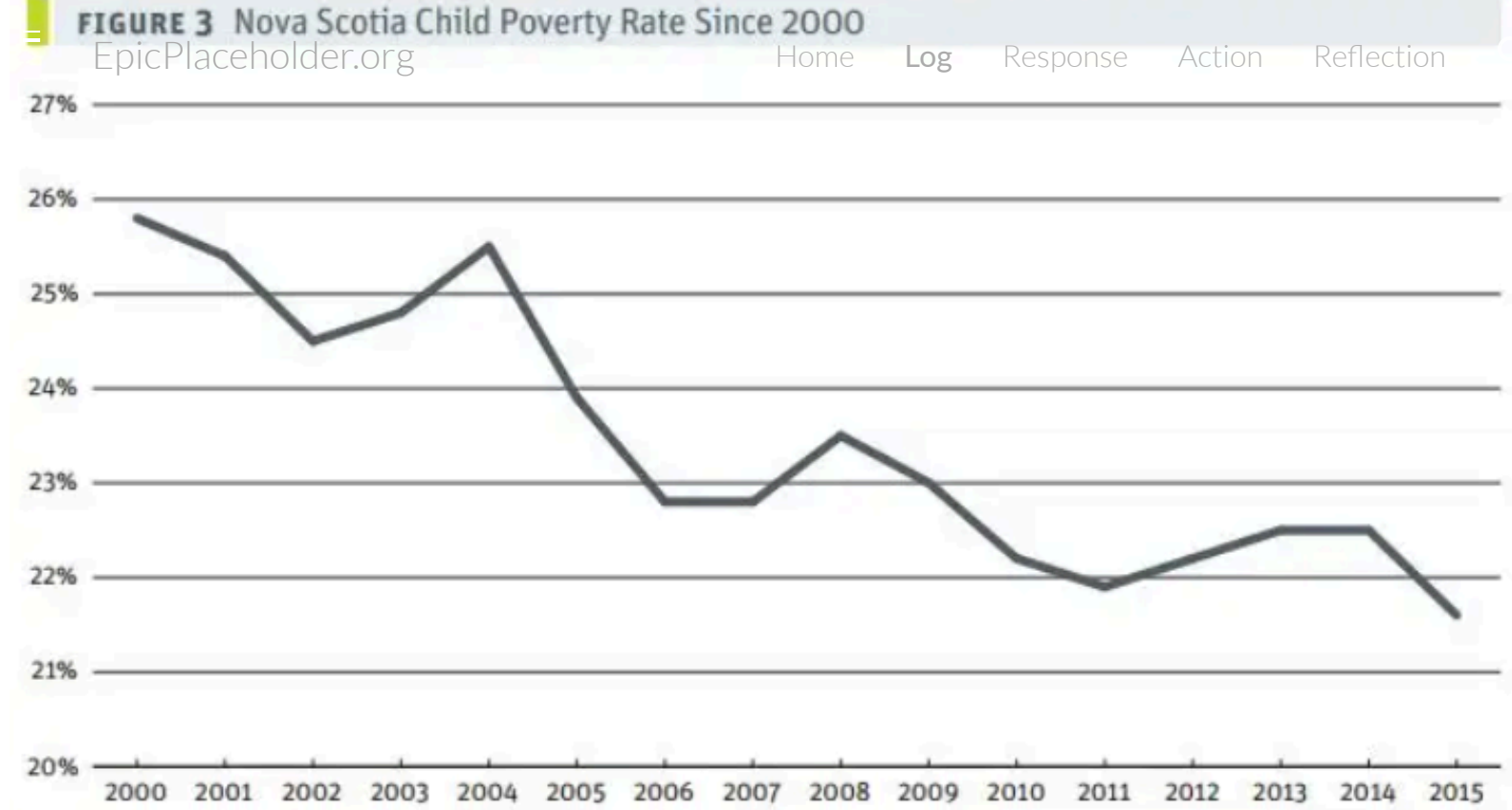
If you said kid 1, you're hypothetically right, but we can't know for sure which kid is in the most danger. Let's take a closer look.

Kid 2 really lives in an abusive foster home funded by the government. He is neglected and bullied by the other children, and he has to take care of his 5 month old sister and his 2 year old sister. He is prohibited from going to school. He says that he has no hope for getting adopted because him and his sisters each have a disability.

Kid 3's parents are working 2 full-time jobs to just barely get by, and they're stressed out because the landlord upped their rent. Now this kid has to stop going to school and beg for a part-time job to help. The landlord threatened to kick them out otherwise. This kid has to sell her favourite toys that she'd had since childhood to make extra money. She works as a barista and her boss is thinking about firing her because her customers complained that she was dirty.

Now answer my question again. That's right, you can't determine which of them is suffering more.

The government will usually favor kid 1, despite everything that's going on below the surface. This is why there's so much child poverty around the world. Obviously the government cares, but they don't have time to deal with all the children, so they will attempt to help the one that is 'in the worst situation' first. But really, all children in these situations matter.



NS Child Poverty Rate Since Y2K

This survey graph shows that the Nova Scotian poverty rates have gone down by ~4% from the year 2000 to 2015. This does not mean we can slack off. See globalnews.ca/news.

Thankfully, the main reason the poverty rates have gone down is because the government is trying to help. But sadly, a 4% decrease is not enough. Hypothetically, let's say we took away all the Nova Scotian homeless shelters, and the government didn't have enough funding to work towards helping children. I'm predicting that in about 1 year, the poverty rates would rise straight back up to ~26%. In 2046, the rate could be around 50%. Obviously, I can't give you exact numbers. All I can confidently tell you is if we do nothing, **it will get worse.**

Two authors must contribute here.